

To Whom It May Concern

Date: 20th July 2026

Re: Reference for Tahir Ismail - Student Shadow Week Placement

I am writing to confirm that Tahir Ismail completed a one-week job shadowing placement with our organisation from 13 to 17 July 2026, and to provide an honest reference regarding his conduct and ability during that time.

Over the course of the week, Tahir was rotated through several different teams within the business, each working on distinct areas of software engineering; including cloud architecture, complex systems integration, modern AI-assisted development practices, and simulation/entitlement software. In each setting, he engaged directly with practising engineers, observed real production work, and completed independent analytical tasks based on what he had seen.

Tahir made a strong and consistent impression across every team he worked with. Multiple, entirely independent hosts described him using the same language; inquisitive, engaged, quick to learn, and easy to work with; which speaks to a genuine and repeatable trait rather than a single good day. He was able to grasp not only **what** a system did, but **why** it had been built that way, and he showed a notable ability to relate unfamiliar technical concepts back to ideas he already understood in order to learn them faster.

By the end of the week, Tahir independently compiled his notes, technical analysis, and a reflective account of the key decisions he had observed and delivered a structured final presentation summarising his findings. His strongest area was clearly architecture and systems thinking. He was able to connect ideas across completely unrelated projects into one coherent picture of how software is actually designed, built, and shipped responsibly in a professional environment.

In summary, Tahir approached every task with professionalism, curiosity, and a genuine passion for the field. He was well liked by every team he worked with, took real ownership of his work, and left a strong, positive impression on our organisation. I would be glad to have him shadow with us again, and I have no hesitation in recommending him to any future academic or professional opportunity.

Please feel free to contact me directly should you require any further information.

Kind regards,

Ashley Mullins

Project Manager
Wirk (PTY) Ltd.